

Pharmacy Benefits & Plan FAQ

Prescription Coverage Overview

Our plans cover prescription medications across four tiers. Tier 1 drugs are generic medications with the lowest copay, typically \$5 to \$10 per fill. Tier 2 covers preferred brand-name drugs. Tier 3 covers non-preferred brand-name drugs, which carry a higher copay and may require prior authorization. Tier 4 covers specialty medications, including biologics, which almost always require prior authorization and have the highest copay, typically \$100 to \$150 per fill. Coverage details for a specific medication depend on the member's plan and current formulary status.

Prior Authorization Process

Prior authorization is required before certain medications will be covered, particularly Tier 3 and Tier 4 drugs. The prescribing doctor's office submits a prior authorization request along with clinical justification. Review typically takes 3 to 5 business days for standard requests, or 24 hours for urgent requests marked by the prescriber. If a prior authorization is denied, the member has the right to appeal (see Appeals Process below). A claim submitted for a drug that required prior authorization but did not have one on file will be rejected with the reason "Prior authorization not obtained."

Generic vs. Brand Name Medications

Generic medications contain the same active ingredients as their brand-name equivalents and are approved by regulators as equally safe and effective. Because generics are significantly cheaper, most plans place them in Tier 1 with the lowest copay to encourage their use. Members can ask their pharmacist whether a generic version is available for any prescribed brand-name drug; switching to a generic, when available, is usually the fastest way to lower an out-of-pocket cost.

Mail-Order Pharmacy Program

Members taking a maintenance medication (for a chronic condition, taken regularly for 90 days or more) can enroll in the mail-order pharmacy program to receive a 90-day supply shipped directly to their home, often at a reduced copay compared to three separate 30-day fills at a retail pharmacy. Enrollment takes place through the member portal or by calling customer service; the first mail-order shipment typically arrives within 7 to 10 business days of enrollment.

Specialty Medication Program

Specialty medications - complex drugs for conditions like rheumatoid arthritis, multiple sclerosis, or certain cancers - are managed through a dedicated specialty pharmacy program rather than a standard retail pharmacy. These medications almost always require prior authorization, and a specialty-trained pharmacist works with the member on storage, administration, and side-effect monitoring. Specialty drugs are Tier 4 by default.

Appeals Process for a Denied or Rejected Claim

If a claim is rejected or a prior authorization is denied, the member or their doctor can file a formal appeal within 180 days of the denial notice. The first-level appeal is reviewed by a clinical reviewer not involved in the original decision, typically within 30 days for a standard appeal or 72 hours for an urgent appeal. If the

first-level appeal is also denied, the member has the right to an independent external review by a third party not affiliated with the plan.

Finding an In-Network Pharmacy

Using an in-network pharmacy is required for the standard copay to apply; using an out-of-network pharmacy typically means paying full price and submitting a reimbursement claim afterward, which is often only partially reimbursed. Members can find their nearest in-network pharmacy by ZIP code through the member portal, the mobile app, or by asking customer service during a call.

Contact Information

For questions not covered by this document, or to check the status of a specific claim or prior authorization, members should contact customer service directly. Customer service can verify identity and pull up account-specific details that are not part of this general reference document.